Synergy Klingon: Everyday Conversational Course Plan

tlhIngan Hol yIghoj! — Learn Klingon!

The Philosophy

You don't need to memorize the entire Klingon dictionary. With roughly **50 "brick" words** and **20 "mortar" pieces**, you can build **hundreds** of everyday sentences. Klingon is actually ideal for this approach — its agglutinative grammar means snapping pieces together is literally how the language works.

> **Key difference from English:** Klingon word order is **Object – Verb – Subject** (OVS). So "I see you" becomes *qalegh* — structured as "(you)-(see)-(I)."

Foundation: The Mortar (Verb Prefixes)

These are your **#1 power tool**. Klingon verb prefixes tell you *who is doing what to whom* in a single syllable. Learn these and you can use every verb you'll ever learn.

Prefix	Meaning	Example
jI-	I (do something, no object)	*jISop* — I eat
bI-	You (do something, no object)	*bIQong* — You sleep
ma-	We (do something, no object)	*majaH* — We go
vI-	I → it/him/her	*vIyaj* — I understand it
Da-	You → it/him/her	*Dayaj'aH* — You understand it
qa-	I → you	*qayaj* — I understand you
cho-	You → me	*choyaj* — You understand me
0 (no prefix)	He/she → it/him/her	*yaj* — He/she understands it

> 💡 **Synergy trick:** Each prefix works with ALL verbs. Learning 8 prefixes × 20 verbs = **160 sentences instantly.**

Module 1: Survival Bricks — Eating, Drinking & Getting Around

Verbs (Bricks)

Klingon	Meaning
Sop	eat
tlhutlh	drink
jaH	go
ghoS	come, approach
ba'	sit
Qong	sleep
ghop	grab, take

Nouns (Bricks)

Klingon	Meaning
Soj	food
bIQ	water
HIq	ale/alcohol
Qe'	restaurant
juH	home
pa'	room
raS	table

Mortar: Location Suffix -Daq (at, to, in)

Snap **-Daq** onto any noun to say where you're going or where you are.

🔨 Build sentences!

Klingon	Literal structure	Meaning
jISop	I-eat	I eat.

Klingon	Literal structure	Meaning
Qe'Daq jISop	restaurant-at I-eat	I eat at the restaurant.
bIQ vItlhutlh	water I(it)-drink	I drink water.
juHDaq majaH	home-to we-go	We go home.
yIba'!	(command)-sit	Sit down!
HIq DatlhutlH'a'?	ale you(it)-drink-?	Do you drink ale?

> 📝 **Mortar note:** Adding **-'a'** to the end of any sentence makes it a **yes/no question**. Instant question power!

Module 2: Opinions & Feelings

Verbs (Bricks)

Klingon	Meaning
parHa'	like (lit. "un-dislike")
par	dislike
neH	want
Qub	think
yaj	understand
ghoj	learn
SaH	care about, be concerned

Adjectives/States (Bricks)

Klingon	Meaning
QaQ	be good
qab	be bad
nI'	be long
tIQ	be old (things)

Klingon	Meaning
chu'	be new
Daj	be interesting

> 💡 In Klingon, adjectives ARE verbs. So *Daj Soj* means "The food is interesting" (literally: "interesting food" or "food is-interesting").

Mortar: -qu' (emphasis / very) and -be' (not/negation)

🔨 Build sentences!

Klingon	Meaning
Soj vIparHa'	I like the food.
QaQqu'!	It's very good!
bIQ vIneH	I want water.
jIyajbe'	I don't understand.
Daj tlhIngan Hol	Klingon is interesting.
HIq DaparHa''a'?	Do you like ale?
ghojqu' puq	The child learns a lot.

Module 3: Talking & Social Interaction

Verbs (Bricks)

Klingon	Meaning
jatlh	speak, say
ghel	ask
jang	answer, reply
QIn	message (noun)
nob	give
Hev	receive

Klingon	Meaning
ghom	meet, encounter
tlho'	thank

Nouns (Bricks)

Klingon	Meaning
jup	friend
be'	woman
loD	man
puq	child
ghot	person
pong	name
Hol	language

Mortar: -wIj (my), -lIj (your), -Daj (his/her)

Possessive suffixes snap right onto nouns.

🔨 Build sentences!

Klingon	Meaning
tlhIngan Hol vIjatlh	I speak Klingon.
nuq ponglIj?	What is your name?
jupwIj Daghom'aH?	Did you meet my friend?
qatlho'	I thank you. / Thank you.
yIjatlh!	Speak!
yIjang!	Answer!
Hol Dajqu'	Language is very interesting.

Module 4: Time, Place & Getting Specific

Time Words (Mortar)

Klingon	Meaning
DaH	now
wa'leS	tomorrow
wa'Hu'	yesterday
tugh	soon
not	never
reH	always
rut	sometimes

Question Words (Mortar)

Klingon	Meaning
nuq?	What?
'Iv?	Who?
nuqDaq?	Where?
qatlh?	Why?
chay'?	How?

Mortar: Verb suffixes for tense

Suffix	Meaning
-pu'	completed (past perfective)
-taH	ongoing/continuous
-laH	can, able to

🔨 **Build sentences!**

Klingon	Meaning
DaH jISoptaH	I am eating now.
wa'leS Qe'Daq majaH	Tomorrow we go to the restaurant.
tlhIngan Hol DajatlhlaH'a'?	Can you speak Klingon?
wa'Hu' HIq vItlhutlhpu'	Yesterday I drank ale.
nuqDaq juHlIj?	Where is your home?
reH Soj QaQ vIneH	I always want good food.
chay' jIghoj?	How do I learn?

Module 5: Courtesy, Small Talk & Personality

Klingon culture values directness, but that doesn't mean you can't be social!

Useful Phrases (Pre-Built Bricks)

Klingon	Meaning
nuqneH?	What do you want? (standard greeting)
Qapla'!	Success! (farewell/toast)
lu' / luq	Okay, agreed
ghobe'	No
HISlaH	Yes
majQa'!	Well done! / Bravo!
bIlughbej	You are certainly right.
jIQochbe'	I don't disagree. (Klingon politeness!)
nuq DaneH?	What do you want?
yIDoghQo'!	Don't be silly!

Extra Personality Verbs

Klingon	Meaning
Hagh	laugh
bel	be pleased
tIv	enjoy
boch	be shiny, shine
belHa'	be displeased
Dach	be absent

🔨 Build sentences!

Klingon	Meaning
Soj vItIv	I enjoy the food.
maHaghtaH!	We are laughing!
jIbeltaH	I am pleased.
bItIv'a'?	Are you enjoying (yourself)?
majQa'! QaQqu' Soj!	Well done! The food is very good!

The Synergy Cheat Sheet: Your Combo Formula

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[Time word] + [Noun+Daq] + [Noun(object)] + [Prefix+Verb+Suffix]
(when)        (where)       (what)           (who does what)
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Example build:

- *DaH* (now) + *Qe'Daq* (at restaurant) + *Soj* (food) + *vISopneH* (I want to eat)
- → **DaH Qe'Daq Soj vISoptaH** — "I'm eating food at the restaurant now."

Your Brick & Mortar Inventory

Category	Count	Combinations Unlocked
Verb prefixes	8	Multiply every verb × 8
Core verbs	~30	240 basic sentences
Nouns	~20	Slot into any sentence
Location suffix (-Daq)	1	20 place phrases
Possessives (-wIj, -lIj, -Daj)	3	60 "my/your/his" phrases
Verb suffixes (-be', -qu', -pu', -taH, -laH, -'a')	6	Multiply every sentence × 6
Time words	7	Add timing to any sentence
Question words	5	Turn statements into questions

> **Conservative estimate:** These ~80 pieces let you build well over **1,000 unique everyday sentences**.

Suggested Practice Path

1. **Week 1–2:** Module 1 + all verb prefixes. Practice snapping every verb with every prefix.
2. **Week 3:** Module 2. Add opinions to everything. ("I like the food." "The water is good." "The room is bad.")
3. **Week 4:** Module 3. Start having simple social exchanges.
4. **Week 5:** Module 4. Add time and questions to everything you've learned.
5. **Week 6:** Module 5. Add personality. Start combining freely across all modules.

Daily drill: Pick 3 bricks and 2 mortars. See how many sentences you can build in 5 minutes.

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tlhIngan Hol Dajqu'. yIghoj! QaQjaj! Klingon is very interesting. Learn it! May it be good!